



The web's next 25 years

The WWW is 25 years old, but how will it evolve in the next quarter century? We investigate: <http://dgit.in/1gUo3oA>



Universe's size

A very easy explanation to understanding the size and scope of the universe. <http://dgit.in/OUxCxH>

Tablets under ₹25,000

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The defining benchmark of a Post PC era is that tablets are becoming hugely popular and are giving a stiff competition to laptops and ultrabooks. And why not? They are much more portable and offer almost all the features and capabilities one can get on a laptop. Most modern-day tablets are easily as powerful (if not more) as two-three year old laptops.

The 'slate' has been prevalent for quite a few years but the modern age tablet gained popularity and traction in the year 2010. In our opinion the credit goes to Apple for shaping the tablet market when it released the first iPad in 2010 and pushed tablet segment into the mainstream consumer market. The company also brought in capacitive touchscreens to the tablet category which meant that users could just tap away with their fingers without having to rely on a stylus pen. A number of manufacturers followed Apple's move and today every hardware-based technology company operating in

the consumer space has a tablet to offer.

According to the International Data Corp. (IDC) the year 2013 saw a rise of 50.6% in tablet sales with the worldwide tablet shipments totalling to 217.1 million, an increase from 144.2 million in 2012. For the Indian market, researchers have predicted that the period of 2013-2014 will see a boost of 50% in the sales on tablets. These numbers are actually huge and are a big threat for laptop makers as the tablet has been marginalizing PCs and laptops for quite some time. A large chunk of the total number of tablets in the market is occupied by Android as it has become the dominating platform in the mobile device industry purely by number of devices adopting it. Apart from Android one can even get their hands on a Windows 8.1 running tablet under a budget of ₹25,000 which provides the Modern UI, as well as proper desktop mode just like a PC.

Today, manufacturers like Apple and Samsung offer tablets in a premium range but a large portion of consumers in the Indian market opt for more affordable tablets to fit their budgets. While we are on the subject, the budget category of tablets has widened a lot and with Indian brands bringing in a mix of their own products, there has been an increase in variety as well. If we look back to 2013, getting your hands on a powerful tablet meant shelling out a lot of money. But times have changed and one can easily get a tablet running on a quad-core processor with plenty of features under a budget of ₹20,000 without breaking a sweat.

For this shootout we have picked tablets from well-known companies and also some indig-

enous brands which provide some competitive features. The focus here is on tablets selling around ₹25,000 which attracts the majority of the consumers. We have included eight Android tablets namely the Dell Venue 7 and Venue 8, iberry Auxus CoreX8, iBall Slide 3G Q1035, Micromax Canvas Tab, Google Nexus 7 (2013), MTV Slash 4X and Simmtronics XPad Turbo. We have also included two Windows 8.1 tablets one from Dell and one from Acer.

THE PLATFORMS

Android had stepped into the tablet game by releasing a different version altogether (3.0 Honeycomb) which was specifically designed for tablets. It did not gain a lot of popularity back then, so Google scrapped it off and made a unified version (4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich) that would run both on smartphones and tablets.

Today the platform is on the verge of becoming the most selling tablet operating system and the numbers are just going stronger by the day. Almost all of the Android tablets that we have tested run on Android 4.2 and the only tablet with the latest KitKat update was the Nexus 7. Hopefully manufacturers will be announcing some new tablet this year with Google's latest 4.4.2 update. With almost 2 million apps available on the Google Play store, Android tablets are poised to take over the industry.

When Microsoft had announced that Windows 8 will feature an app ecosystem on top of the traditional desktop layout, it seemed logical that the OS would be ported to tablet devices. The good part is that one can get a full-fledged desktop/laptop experience but the bad part is that using its



MTV Slash 4X

touchscreen on the desktop mode is a real pain. The tiled UI is similar to what we have seen on Windows Phone devices and the apps work in a similar fashion. With the app development steadily going stronger, Windows 8.1 tablets could soon gain a decent market share.

PERFORMANCE

Tablets today offer a blazing performance and manufacturers have to cram in some high-end hardware to achieve that. Apart from hardware, an optimized OS is very crucial. Now it doesn't make sense buying a tablet with a good set of specs but a sluggish interface, does it?

The Acer Iconia W4 runs on an Intel Bay Trail processor with four cores which means that the tablet can perform functions as smoothly as one can do on a laptop. Since the tablet runs Windows, you can install proper softwares like PC games as well as apps from the Windows App store. The tablet didn't disappoint us at any time as it managed to run



Simmtronics XPad Turbo